

In a Nutshell

	Xbox 360	PlayStation 3	Nintendo Wii
Processor	IBM PowerPC-based custom-built processor with 3 symmetrical cores, running at 3.2 GHz	Sony-Toshiba-IBM Cell Processor with 8 cores, running at 3.2 GHz	IBM PowerPC-based "Broadway" CPU
GPU	Custom-built ATI Graphics with Unified Shader Architecture	NVIDIA RSX GPU	ATI "Hollywood" GPU
Output Resolution	Up to 1080i, lower resolutions scaled up	Up to 1080p, no scaling	Up to 480p
Storage	20 GB HDD (Premium System only) Xbox 360 Memory Unit	60 GB HDD, Memory Stick (Standard and Duo) / Stick Pro, SD, CompactFlash	512 MB Flash Memory, GameCube Memory Card, SD
Connectors	3 USB 2.0 ports	4 front and 2 rear USB 2.0 ports	2 USB 2.0 ports
Connectivity	Wi-Fi, Ethernet	Wi-Fi, Ethernet, Bluetooth 2.0	Wi-Fi, Ethernet (via Ethernet to USB adapter)
Bundle	"Core System: Console, one wired controller, composite AV cable Premium System: Console, one wireless controller, media remote, HDMI cables, 20 GB HDD"	Console, SIXAXIS Wireless Controller	Console, Wii remote, Nunchuck, sensor bar for remote
Price	"Core System: Rs 19,000; Premium System: Rs 23,000"	Rs 39,990	Rs 19,000 (grey market); Rs 15,000 (expected retail price)

games we tried it out, though, it seemed rather twitchy—its lightness makes it easy to over-tilt, even when you're not in the throes of excitement. We'd have appreciated something that felt a tad more substantial. Overall, this has potential, provided game developers are able to use it properly.

Everything about the controller is the same as the PS2's, but the L2 and R2 buttons have been replaced with analogue triggers, and they're plain awful. They're convex, for one, so your fingers are going to slip off them when you apply too much force—not too palatable when it's what's keeping your

character alive or your engine revving. They're also placed awkwardly, and holding them down is decidedly uncomfortable—this was quite obviously an afterthought.

Going Online

You'll be able to access the PlayStation Network (PSN) free as soon as you buy your console, so you'll have access to all the free content—game demos, HD videos et al—and will be able to play multiplayer games, but you won't have access to paid content till later this year, once some issues with the payment gateway have been ironed out. Later this year, we'll see PlayStation Home, which seems to be a Second Life of sorts. You'll be able to create your own avatar, build your virtual home, buy virtual furniture, play virtual games, die a virtual death (we're not so sure about this bit), and so on.

The Gamer's Burden

As with the 360, by playing with the PS3 on a standard-definition TV, you're preventing it from fulfilling its destiny. If you have no qualms about shelling out the Rs 39,990 for the 60 GB unit, we're assuming you don't have any hang-ups about plunging for an HDTV as well. Unfortunately, you'll have to go hunting for your own HDMI cables—acceptable ones should come for around Rs 3,000; better ones, even more.

Titles will release at Rs 2,499 each, and there's a slim chance that this number will fall—Sony has already started replicating PS2 DVDs in India, bringing some prices down to as low as Rs 999, and we're hoping this happens for the PS3 as well.

And from the darkness, another emerges...

The Nintendo Wii

Look at this thing. That small, clean white body belies its cruel black heart. After all, what manner of insolent machine seeks to get people off the couch and exercise? And then

